Who Does What for Your Husband

The family's regular care tasks in one place: who does each, when it was last talked about, and which ones nobody has agreed to.

The pills, the rides, the pharmacy run, the forms that come in the mail. Some of it is yours, some is the kids', and some has never been anyone's in particular.

This page doesn't ask whether the work is shared out well. It asks what the regular tasks are, who does each one today, whether that was ever agreed, and when anyone last talked about it.

REGULAR TASK	WHO DOES IT NOW	AGREED, OR ASSUMED?	LAST TALKED ABOUT
Setting out his medications and keeping track of refills			
Pharmacy pickups			
Making his appointments and keeping the calendar			
Driving him to appointments and errands			
Talking with his doctor's office			
Meals: the shopping and the cooking			
Laundry and keeping the house			
Help with dressing, bathing or grooming, if there is any			
The mail, forms and other paperwork			
Keeping the kids and the rest of the family up to date			

Tasks nobody has agreed to, and who will bring each one up

Any row marked “assumed,” or with no name in it. Put a name next to each for who will raise it, not for who should take it on.

FOR EXAMPLE Pharmacy pickups: I do them, and nobody ever decided that. I'll bring it up with our daughter on Sunday.

Who filled this in, and on what date

How to use it

- List what happens in a typical week, not what was planned. Cross out any row that isn't part of your week, and add your own on the blank lines.
- Write “agreed” only where the people involved have actually talked about it. Everything else is “assumed,” which is a description, not a complaint.
- If you don't know who does something, write “not sure” and ask. Don't guess.
- For “last talked about,” a month and a year will do. “Never” is an answer too.

What this page doesn't do

It doesn't say whether the work is shared fairly, whether a task is being done well enough, or whether anyone should be doing more. It shows who does what today, and which of it has never been said out loud.

Ready for the next step?

You can see every regular task on one page, who does it, and which ones were never agreed. The care interview adds the rest of the picture: it goes through your husband's situation and the help around him area by area, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The kinds of task in the first rows follow the National Institute on Aging's list of what caregivers may help with. The columns come from the Family Care Roadmap's working list for this step.

1. National Institute on Aging, Getting Started With Caregiving